



After adding the transitions in between the scenes

of several effects such as Additive Blend, Blinds, CheckerBox, Blur Fade, and many more.

These transitions can be added between the scenes by just dragging and dropping them in the desired place.

STEP 6 Once you have added all the effects you want, click on 'Export' to bring up the window of the final stage, where you can specify various settings regarding the video file to be output.

Here, you may select an export template from DVD, SVCD, VCD, or Custom, if you wish to specify the format of the output video file. In file types, the options available are MPEG-1, MPEG-2 and AVI.

In the 'Export Template', when you select DVD, it essentially means the MPEG-2 video standard. This standard is known for its high video as well as audio quality.

If you choose NTSC, the video resolution chosen is 720 x 480 at 29.97 frames per second and the bit-rate is 5,073 kbps.

If you wish to choose the PAL standard, the resolution becomes 720 x 576 at 25 frames per second with the bit-rate remaining the same. You can configure the different settings by clicking the 'Configure' button. In the 'General' tab, you can choose the video standard according to your country or between PAL and NTFS.

In the DVD-Video tab, you can choose the aspect ratio from between 4:3, 16:9 and Automatic. In quality settings, you can choose from Automatic, High, Standard, Long Play, Extended Play, Super Long Play and Custom. If you choose



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custom, you can specify the bit-rate and resolution for the output video.

In the 'Sample Format' dropdown menu, you can specify the interlacing method. It is best to set this as Automatic. You can also specify the Encoding

You can also view the duration of video that can be accommodated on one disc. This video format requires the highest amount of space.

When you choose VCD, the output video is created in MPEG-1 format. Resolution for PAL is 352 x 288 at 25 fps.

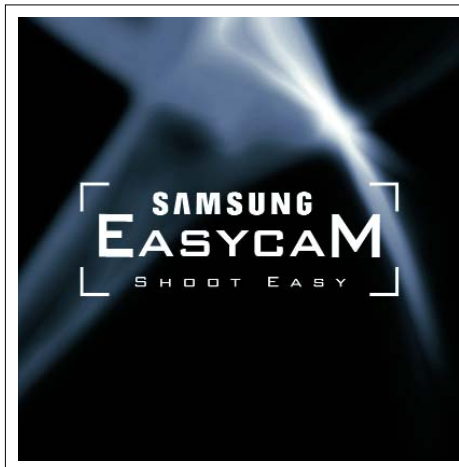
In the 'Custom' template, if you select MPEG format, then you can also specify an aspect ratio of your choice. If you select AVI, you can select the compression codecs for video and audio. You can also specify the video format such as PAL, NTSC or Custom.

When 'Custom' is selected, the frame rate and resolution can be specified. Once you do this, choose a location of your choice for your output file

and name the file.

When you click 'Export', the final file with the transition effects you added is created. It's as simple as that. ■

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mode—choose between 'Fast' and 'High quality'. Finally, you can specify the audio format—you can choose between Dolby Digital (AC-3) 2.0 and Stereo. Choose 'Stereo'.

► Other Software You Could Try...

Adobe After Effects 6.5: This is a high-end tool for video editing and motion graphics. It has stunning 2D and 3D transition effects that create professional-quality videos. It is available in Standard Edition, which costs \$299 (approx Rs 13,000) and Professional Edition, which costs \$999 (approx Rs 43,450). Additionally, the Professional Edition has flexible Motion Tracking, powerful scripting, precise keying and matte tools, advanced visual effects and much more. These are some features the Standard Edition does not have.

MainConcept MainActor v5: This tool grants you high-end power at entry-level price. It has all the necessary features for good quality video editing, plus a dynamic interface. The demo version can be downloaded from www.mainconcept.com. The retail version is available for \$199 (approx Rs 8,650).

Windows Movie Maker 2.1: Windows Movie Maker 2.1 is included in Windows XP SP2 and Windows XP Professional x64 Edition. This tool can capture—as well as edit—videos from various devices including DV Cams. You can create home movies and give them a professional look from the 130 new titles, effects and transition options that are available with this software.